Neolithic Beasts

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Second Chances
Member

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Neolithic Beasts

#1
03-30-2016, 12:25 PM

Because you know every gameline will have a Neolithic thread by the end of the week 😉

Actually what prompted this was the thought of using Shattered Time as lair trait and just how horrifying that could be. What would happen if a Beast had a chamber of its layer located in a Pocket of Time that was finally completely eroded? I think there is a lot of interesting stuff for Beasts to play with here.

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | **Patreon**| **He/His** | **Currently Writing**: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast I Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist I Hunter I Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

Tags: None

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Arcanist
Member

03-30-2016, 12:58 PM

#2

Just a thought I had, but should Neolithic Beasts be able to feed via Nightmares *all* the time, instead of just when they're starved? It would be the same dice pool, and it would still attract Heroes, (maybe even regular people with a certain level of Occult?) but I know my idea was that pre-major civilization humans were still more closely attuned to the Primordial Dream, making inflicting Nightmares a more viable form of feeding. This wouldn't take away from sating Hungers, but would be an option for Beasts that want to run off into the wilderness and be



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more isolated creatures roaming the Otherworlds.

Side note, Beast Kinship with Pangaeans, yeah?

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Second Chances
Member



Join Date: Dec 2014
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03-30-2016, 01:24 PM #3

It also occurs to me that Beasts with fire based layers would be even more horrific in this era both to animals and villages. Yet, they may be something that Neolithic people have to deal with if they are to relight their ceremonial fires.

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | **Patreon**| **He/His** | **Currently Writing**: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast I Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist I Hunter I Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

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YeOfLittleFaith
Member



Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 1159

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03-30-2016, 01:30 PM #4

The ability to satiate themselves with nightmares all the time sounds appropriate, given the short mention of Beasts seems to hint that they didn't need to feed directly back then. The mummy View From Without in their corebook also commented that the Begotten seemed less hungry back in Irem, and the Neolithic Chapter is set even before that.

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03-30-2016, 01:36 PM #5

My idea for a major change for the era is that the Primordial Dream and the Temenos are not firmly divided yet. Horror Lairs open into the broader Temenos and they're the major threat Wise (Mage) explorers have to deal with and vice-versa.

glamourweaver
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 7541

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The spread of the agricultural revolution is pushing them back though, and as the Wise map the Astral "Here Be Dragons" gets pushed further and further away.

Check out my expansion to the Realm of Brass and Shadow

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Satchel
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 9826

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03-30-2016, 01:58 PM #6

> *Originally posted by* ***YeOfLittleFaith***
> *The ability to satiate themselves with nightmares all the time sounds appropriate, given the short mention of Beasts seems to hint that they didn't need to feed directly back then. The mummy View From Without in their corebook also commented that the Begotten seemed less hungry back in Irem, and the Neolithic Chapter is set even before that.*

I'm inclined to suspect that the lower human population meant proportionally and numerically fewer Beasts and a longer interval of Satiety loss over time, but I don't feel that the Horror independently disturbing the Dream is quite appropriate in early-agricultural times where Pangaeans demonstrate a similar Astral mobility to the Begotten and imply the ability to enter individual Oneiroi through the Temenos exists as a regular function of travel therein.

Resident Lore-Hound
Currently Consuming: *Demon: the Descent 1e*

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YeOfLittleFaith
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
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03-30-2016, 02:11 PM #7

Hrm. When you put it like that, maybe not.

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Satchel
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 9826

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03-30-2016, 02:47 PM #8

> *Originally posted by* ***YeOfLittleFaith***
> *Hrm. When you put it like that, maybe not.*

Like, I'm reasonably sure Mage 2e giving us a bigger picture of how Astral navigation works will open up a few more venues for Beasts to readily feed in, but Inflicting Nightmares is kind of inherently an emergency feature until one of the Children starts being really supernaturally active and/or strong enough for it to be a consistent mode of sustenance.

Resident Lore-Hound
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YeOfLittleFaith
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 1159

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03-30-2016, 03:07 PM #9

Details in Beast of how their methods changed over time by necessity due to the busy denseness of the growing human collective, and the wording on the sidebar, made me go immediately to the possibility they could get by without delivering fear or lessons directly. It seemed like the obvious way in which they could be said to feed more easily. In hindsight, the resonance of the traumas and wisdoms given by their predations lingering longer in the human mind and being simpler to confront, hence making more satisfying meals, seems like the correct answer as to what was different for them back then.

Presumably, the majority of Heroes then had also not had their roles in this cycle confused or suffocated by thousands of years of mythical structure or difficulty in *listening* to what the Dream tells as opposed to just hearing and letting deluded interpretations guide them.

Last edited by YeOfLittleFaith; 03-30-2016, 03:28 PM.

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Arcanist
Member

Join Date: Oct 2014

04-02-2016, 02:58 PM #10

Relevant bits from Terry Pratchett's **Hogfather**. The monologue of the Tooth Fairy (IE. The first Boogeyman, IE. a Neolithic Beast/Dark Mother stand-in for these purposes)

"I was the dark in the cave! I was the shadow in the trees! You've heard about... the primal scream? That was... at *me*! I was... And then, that thing, you know, that thing... all light and bright... lightning you could carry, hot, little sunshine, and then there was no more dark, just shadows, and then you made axes, axes in the forest, and then... and then..." [...] "But, if you had seen me in the old days... when they came down into the deep caves to draw their hunting pictures... I could roar in their heads... so that their stomachs dropped out their bottoms...

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Oh, others came later... they never knew that first fine terror. All they knew was dark corners. I had *been* the dark! I was the... first!"

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falco1029

Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 1045

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04-05-2016, 01:42 PM #11

I believe the Beast book mentions Heroes had more of a purpose in older times too, providing guidance to deal with the horrors in the night, rather than being ones to hunt them too often. I'll have to check when I get home later. But it makes me think that nightmare feeding didn't create Heroes as easily, and those that were made were sort of 'expected', a natural way to guide humanity. So I could definitely see astral based feeding being more common back then, along with the occasional person that doesn't listen to the Heroes. In fact, it might even be more symbiotic between Heroes and Beasts then; beasts don't need to provide the lesson themselves, the Heroes do that, the beasts just enforce it when someone strays where they shouldn't.



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YeOfLittleFaith

Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 1159

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04-05-2016, 01:56 PM #12

Reminder that feeding *attracts* Heroes, not create them. In the final text, at least. It's all but stated that things have gone askew with the roles of Beasts and Heroes both, likely because of the development and proliferation of humanity and civilization.

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Arcanist
Member

Join Date: Oct 2014
Posts: 1232

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04-05-2016, 02:05 PM #13

This ^

I still stand by the belief that while the Hero is the *interpreter* of the wisdom in nightmares, it is the Beast who is the *keeper* of this wisdom. More importantly, Heroes sense *any* disturbances to the Primordial Dream caused by fear, not just those caused by Beasts (though Beasts are, for obvious reasons, more than likely to cause disturbances themselves). So, something is out there causing fear, the Hero seeks out the Beast, and the Beast goes "Hold up, I didn't do this. But I know some people, so let me make a few calls."

The thing about a lot of these early mythic monsters is that, even if they're predisposed to cause mayhem, in the earliest myths the Beasts are just subdued by the Hero, not killed. The god bends the monster to their will for the benefit of the community. Never forget that Hades named his ferocious three-headed dog "Spot" or that Marduk was cool with the Sirrush. Heck, the Irkalla was guarded by *the* Ugallu. A Beast preys upon a community, sure, but if they can reach an accord, a Beast could be a valuable asset.

I also don't remember where in the forums I saw this, but I'm also partial to the idea of Beast Lairs connecting a little more closely to the Temenos than it would in later days- the wild is just outside the village, after all, so the Wise who go wandering the Astral to find other Temenos Realms have to deal with areas marked "Here There Be Dragons". Also, Pangaeans can wander around in there, and those guys are terrifying, even to a Beast.

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falco1029
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 1045

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04-05-2016, 02:56 PM #14

> *Originally posted by* ***YeOfLittleFaith***
> *Reminder that feeding attracts Heroes, not create them. In the final text, at least. It's all but stated that things have gone askew with the roles of Beasts and Heroes both, likely because of the development and proliferation of humanity and civilization.*

Ah, well, that fits what I said even better then. There might be far fewer Heroes, more closely matching the number of Beasts, who calm people's nightmares but also use them as a way to reinforce how to stay safe. If you have a nightmare about a terrible creature in the forest, maybe don't go into the forest alone at night. Or else the same Beast that caused that nightmare will reinforce that point by taking a bite out of you and sending you running back to the village (But for most Beasts, that'll be it, and it'll drive the point home so the Spirit-Claimed monstrosity in those same woods can't get you later).



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ElvesofZion
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 1086

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04-05-2016, 02:57 PM #15

*Originally posted by **Arcanist***

I also don't remember where in the forums I saw this, but I'm also partial to the idea of Beast Lairs connecting a little more closely to the Temenos than it would in later days- the wild is just outside the village, after all, so the Wise who go wandering the Astral to find other Temenos Realms have to deal with areas marked "Here There Be Dragons". Also, Pangaeans can wander around in there, and those guys are terrifying, even to a Beast.

It was pointed out (by Dave) that there really isn't a separation between the Priomordial Dream and the Temenos. The Primordial Dream and the Bright Dream together ARE the Temenos. That's true in the modern day too.

(he/him/his)



Backer #2010

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